

1.1 Capitalism vs. Communism: Ideological Foundations (Part 1)

- **Democratic Capitalism: The American Paradigm**
 - The United States championed a system rooted in constitutional democracy, prioritizing individual civil liberties and representative governance.
 - Economically, the American framework relied on free-market capitalism, emphasizing private property, competition, and entrepreneurial freedom.
 - American leadership believed that decentralized decision-making and minimal state economic control were necessary to prevent totalitarian overreach.

1.1 Capitalism vs. Communism: Ideological Foundations (Part 2)

- **Authoritarian Communism: The Soviet Paradigm**

- In stark contrast, the Soviet Union operated under a single-party authoritarian regime, centralizing absolute power within the Communist Party.
- The Soviet command economy functioned through strict state ownership of all production means, fundamentally abolishing private property rights.
- Marxist-Leninist ideology argued that true collective equality required the complete elimination of capitalist class structures via state control.

1.1 Capitalism vs. Communism: Ideological Foundations (Part 3)

- **The WWII Baseline Alliance (1941-1945)**
 - During World War II, the United States and the Soviet Union formed a reluctant strategic alliance strictly out of necessity to defeat Nazi Germany.
 - This temporary partnership required both superpowers to momentarily sideline their profound ideological differences to confront an existential threat.
 - Despite massive American Lend-Lease aid sustaining the Soviet war effort, deep-seated mutual suspicion persisted among military intelligence ranks.

1.1 Capitalism vs. Communism: Ideological Foundations (Part 4)

- **The Sudden Ideological Pivot Post-1945**

- The total collapse of the Axis powers in 1945 created a massive geopolitical power vacuum across the entirety of the devastated European continent.
- The irreconcilable nature of their competing ideologies completely negated traditional diplomacy, rapidly dissolving the precarious wartime alliance.
- This fundamental ideological rupture made continued post-war cooperation practically impossible, setting the definitive stage for the Cold War era.